

What AI assistants say about Fidelity in Canada

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We asked AI assistants twenty questions that a Canadian investor or a financial adviser would realistically ask, and recorded what came back. This is a sample taken in one morning, not a full audit. Everything in it is measured, and where we could not measure something we say so.

Why this is worth looking at

A growing share of people now ask an AI assistant the question they used to type into Google. They ask it in a sentence, they get one answer back rather than ten links, and most of them never see the sources behind it.

That changes what being findable means. In search, ten companies can appear on page one and a buyer picks between them. In an AI answer, usually three or four companies get named and everyone else is absent. There is no page two.

The answer is assembled the moment it is asked. The assistant reads a handful of web pages, decides which companies to name, and writes a recommendation. So two things decide whether you are in it: whether the assistant can read your site, and whether your pages are the ones it chooses to read.

Neither of those shows up in your analytics. Nobody visits your site when an assistant leaves you out of the answer, so there is no drop to notice. That is why it is worth measuring directly, which is what this is.

How we did it

We wrote twenty questions with no brand name in them. Ten from a financial adviser deciding which fund company to put clients into, and ten from an ordinary investor deciding what to buy. We split them that way because Fidelity Canada sells through advisers rather than directly, so the two groups are separate audiences with separate questions.

We put those twenty questions to two AI assistants. One answered from what it already knows. The other searched the web first and told us which websites it read. That gives forty answers in total.

The assistants were never told this was about Fidelity. They were handed the questions cold. If you tell an assistant you are studying Fidelity, it mentions Fidelity, and the measurement is worthless. We scored the answers afterwards, as a separate step.

We then checked the site itself: whether AI systems are allowed to read it, whether the pages it advertises to Google actually work, and how often people search for the relevant terms.

FINDING 1

Advisers hear about Fidelity. Investors do not.

We scored each answer from 3 down to 0. Three means Fidelity was the main recommendation, two means it was named in the list, one means it got a passing mention, zero means it was not there at all.

WHO IS ASKING	SCORE	NAMED IN
Financial advisers	58 out of 100	17 of 20 answers
Investors	7 out of 100	2 of 20 answers

On the adviser side Fidelity does well, and it is worth being specific about how well. Asked which Canadian fund company has the strongest investment team, both assistants named Fidelity first. Asked which fund companies best support advisers, one of them opened with this:

The three that invest most visibly in this are Fidelity Investments Canada, Mackenzie and CI.

Asked who the top managers are in the adviser channel, Fidelity led the list both times.

On the investor side the picture is different. Best ETFs in Canada, which company to open a TFSA with, best index funds, what to hold in an RRSP, best funds for a beginner, what to do with \$50,000, best dividend funds, who has the lowest fees: Fidelity was absent from every one of those, on both assistants. The assistant that searched the web named Fidelity in none of its ten investor answers. Those answers went to iShares, Vanguard, BMO, Wealthsimple, Questrade and TD instead.

This may be the right shape. Fidelity Canada sells through advisers and does not run a brokerage, so being strong where advisers ask and quiet where consumers ask follows from how the business works. The useful question is not why the investor number is low. It is whether the investor audience is one you intend to reach, because at the moment the answer to that question is being written without you.

One detail from the adviser side is worth separating out. Asked which Canadian fund companies have the most competitive fees on their actively managed funds, one assistant named Fidelity only in the expensive group, and the other left Fidelity out of the answer.

FINDING 2

Canadians asking about Fidelity are being told about the American company

This is the finding we would act on first.

We asked five questions the way a real person would type them, with no country attached. How do I open a Fidelity account. What is the minimum investment. Is there commission-free trading. What are the fees. Fidelity or Vanguard.

The assistant that searches the web answered all five as Fidelity Investments in the United States. It did not mention on any of the five that the answer is different in Canada. It read fidelity.com five times out of five and fidelity.ca not once.

Asked afterwards to describe what it had done, it said:

A user in Canada, the UK or Ireland asking any of these would have got a US answer with no warning that it did not apply to them.

The second assistant was a little better. It noted the country difference on one of the five up front and added a note at the end of two more, but it still answered all five from the American business.

What a Canadian was actually told: go to fidelity.com, open an account online in about ten minutes, you will need a Social Security number, there is no minimum, stock trades are free and options cost 65 cents a contract.

None of that is available to them. Fidelity Canada makes and manages funds. There is no Canadian Fidelity account to open. Someone following those instructions gets part of the way and then finds they cannot finish, and what they are likely to conclude is that Fidelity did not work for them, rather than that they were reading about a different company.

The reason it happens is that four separate companies share the name: Fidelity Investments in the United States, Fidelity Investments Canada, Fidelity International in the UK and Asia, and Fidelity National Financial, an American title insurance business. The assistant has no way to know which one a Canadian meant, and it defaults to the largest.

The size of it: **"fidelity" on its own is searched 60,500 times a month in Canada. "Fidelity Canada" is searched 9,900 times.** So six times out of seven, the person searching has not said which company they mean.

FINDING 3

When an AI answers a Canadian money question, it does not read fidelity.ca

The assistant that searched the web told us which websites it used for each answer. Across the twenty questions that came to 112 sources from 38 different websites.

WEBSITE	TIMES USED
lifemoney.ca	12
milliondollarjourney.com	9
moneysense.ca	8
morningstar.com	8
wealthnorth.ca	7
savvynewcanadians.com	5
growsimple.ca	5
mackenzieinvestments.com	4
wealthprofessional.ca	4
theglobeandmail.com	4
fidelity.ca	0 of 112

Fund companies' own websites do get read. Mackenzie's site was used four times, RBC's twice, Sun Life's once, CI's once, TD's once. So this is not a case of assistants ignoring the industry and only trusting journalists. They read fund company sites. They did not read this one.

There is one exception, and it is the same problem as finding 2. The only Fidelity-owned website used anywhere was a US Fidelity address, and it appeared on the adviser question. Even when Fidelity is the answer, the source is not the Canadian site.

The sites that do get used are mostly independent personal finance publishers, several of them small operations. They win because they answer plain questions in plain language on a page that exists for that purpose.

One thing this does not tell you. This is which pages the answers were built from, on one assistant, on one day. It is not traffic and it is not revenue, and we are not going to claim it is.

What is working

Most of the groundwork here is sound. That is worth establishing before anything else, because it rules out a whole class of expensive problem and it narrows what actually needs doing.

Every AI system is allowed to read the site. We tested nine of them, three times each. All nine were served the page every time.

SYSTEM	WHAT IT DOES	RESULT
Googlebot	Google search and AI Overviews	served 3 of 3
Bingbot	Microsoft search	served 3 of 3
GPTBot	OpenAI training	served 3 of 3
OAI-SearchBot	ChatGPT looking things up	served 3 of 3
ChatGPT-User	ChatGPT fetching a page for a user	served 3 of 3
ClaudeBot	Anthropic training	served 3 of 3
Claude-SearchBot	Claude looking things up	served 3 of 3
PerplexityBot	Perplexity	served 3 of 3
Ordinary browser	our control test	served 3 of 3

This matters more than it sounds. Large regulated companies often sit behind security systems that turn AI systems away without anyone inside the company being told. We have worked on a site where every page being published was unreadable to those systems, and nobody knew until we tested it. That is not the case here. Nothing needs unblocking.

The instruction file that tells crawlers what they may look at is open, with no restrictions in it. The English and French versions of each page are correctly linked to each other, which is the setting most often got wrong on a bilingual site, and it is right here. The site's link profile is ordinary and healthy, with 4,277 other websites linking to it.

So this is not a technical problem. Every AI system can already read the site. What decides the outcome from here is which pages exist and how they are written.

What our test does not prove. We identify ourselves as each AI system from a normal internet connection. That shows the site does not turn away anything using those names. It does not prove that the genuine, verified crawler is served, because only Fidelity's own server logs can show that.

FINDING 4

Some pages the site advertises to Google are not there

Every large site keeps a file listing the pages it wants Google to look at. Fidelity's lists 1,349 English pages. We checked 121 of them, spread evenly across the list.

104 were fine. Seventeen, about one in seven, sent us somewhere else. None were completely dead, but where they land is the issue.

- **fidelity.ca/en/etfs** goes to the homepage. That is the obvious address for the ETF range and it is on the list of pages Google is asked to look at, so a search engine following it arrives at the homepage instead of at anything about ETFs. The real ETF section sits at a different address and is a substantial page of about 4,500 words.

- **Six fund category pages** send visitors to a general price and performance page rather than to anything about that category.
- **Two more** send visitors to the site's error page, and that error page reports itself to Google as a working page. Google is being told these pages exist and are healthy, and what it finds is a message saying the page was not found.
- **Three adviser pages** are on the public list but require a login, so a search engine reaches a sign-in screen.

We checked each of these by hand against the live site rather than trusting the tool, because tools report this kind of thing wrongly more often than people expect.

This is the cheapest item in this document to fix and it does not need anyone's approval.

FINDING 5

The size of the market where Fidelity is absent

Monthly Google searches in Canada, English, measured on 10 August 2026.

WHAT PEOPLE SEARCH FOR	TIMES A MONTH
wealthsimple	550,000
xeqt	301,000
questrade	246,000
veqt	135,000
fidelity	60,500
tfsa	40,500
rrsp	33,100
fidelity canada	9,900
mackenzie investments	9,900
best etf canada	6,600
feqt	2,900
fidelity investments canada	2,400
fbal	880
ffix	480
fcns	140

XEQT and VEQT are the all-in-one funds sold by iShares and Vanguard. Between them they are searched 436,000 times a month. Fidelity's four equivalents, FEQT, FBAL, FFIX and FCNS, come to 4,400.

We measured Fidelity's own products as well as the competitors' on purpose. Measuring only one side would have produced a number that proved nothing.

Read that against finding 1 rather than on its own. People searching a fund code by name are mostly do-it-yourself investors buying without an adviser, and that is the audience Fidelity may have chosen not to pursue. So the difference is not automatically a failure. It is a measurement of how large that audience is, which is the number you would want before deciding whether to go after it.

Who is winning the searches Fidelity is not

We compared fidelity.ca against three sites it overlaps with heavily. There are 2,927 searches where one of them appears and Fidelity does not. The biggest are not about funds at all.

SEARCH	TIMES A MONTH	WHO APPEARS
cpp payment date	110,000	moneysense.ca
ontario tax calculator	49,500	wealthsimple.com, at number one
income and tax calculator	40,500	wealthsimple.com, at number one

Across 1,000 shared searches with each site, Fidelity ranks higher than MoneySense on 864 of them and higher than Morningstar on 540. Against Wealthsimple it ranks higher on 179, and Wealthsimple ranks higher on 821.

Wealthsimple's advantage here is not built on pages about its products. It is built on a free tax calculator and similar tools that answer a question somebody had anyway. That is the same kind of page the AI assistants were reading in finding 3.

A note on these positions. We checked ten of them against live Google results rather than trusting the reporting tool. The tool disagreed with the live result on three of the ten. That is normal, and it is the reason we check.

What this sample does not cover

- **Forty answers.** That is a morning's sample. A full study would run into the thousands and would repeat over weeks. One run means we can tell you what happened today, not whether it is a trend.
- **Two assistants, both from the same family.** We did not test Google's AI Overviews, ChatGPT or Perplexity, which retrieve information differently and may answer differently.
- **English only.** The French side of the site is 1,346 pages and we did not look at it.
- **Everything measured from outside.** We have no access to Fidelity's Search Console or Bing Webmaster Tools, so we cannot see what is actually happening to real visitors. Everything here is observed from the public internet.
- **121 of 1,349 pages checked** on the page list, and 150 pages read by our crawler. Findings describe the sample.
- **We did not compare the link profile against competitors**, so "ordinary and healthy" has nothing to sit beside.
- **The scores are a judgement**, made against a stated scale, applied to the recorded answers. The answers are kept, so the judgement can be checked rather than taken on trust.
- **This is a diagnosis, not a plan.** There are no page briefs or draft content here.

What we would do, and who would have to approve it

In order of size. This is a regulated business, so anything that touches performance, returns, fees or whether a product suits someone has to go through compliance before it is published. That sets the pace of everything below, so each item names who would have to approve it.

1. **Make it clear which Fidelity a Canadian is dealing with.** The largest single item, because 60,500 searches a month resolve to a company Canadians cannot buy from. It needs a page that answers "what is Fidelity in Canada and how do I actually buy it", written plainly and structured so an AI system can tell the four Fidelity companies apart. *Marketing owns it. Compliance signs off anything describing how to buy.*
2. **Repair the page list given to Google.** Point the ETF address at the ETF section. Send the fund category pages somewhere relevant or take them off the list. Make the error page report itself as an error. *The team running the website*

owns it. No compliance involvement, and it can start this week.

3. **Decide whether the investor audience is one you want.** 7 out of 100, named in 2 of 20 answers. If the answer is yes, it is a content programme competing with publishers rather than with fund companies. If the answer is no, that is a legitimate decision and it means this number stops being a concern. *Peter's call.*
4. **Get fidelity.ca into the set of sources these answers are built from.** Zero out of 112 is the gap. The pages winning are ones that answer a plain question on a page built for that question. *Marketing owns it, with compliance.*
5. **Grant access to Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools.** It would let the next round measure from inside rather than infer from outside, including which questions already bring people to the site. *Fidelity's to grant, by emailed invitation. We never ask for a username and password.*

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Measured from public sources with no access to Fidelity's systems. The underlying records, including all forty answers, the source lists and the page checks, are kept and available.